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DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION AND
COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY

DICT CARAGA REGIONAL OFFICE INFORMATION SECURITY POLICY

Version 1.1

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Document Overview

This document serves as the official information security policy for
Department of Information and Communications Technology - Region 13
Treated with confidentiality and intended for authorized personnel only.



VERSION HISTORY

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CHAPTER 1: GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1 Introduction

Information Security fundamentally entails the preservation of confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information. Information security safeguards our data and the data that has been entrusted to us. With this information security policy, we can ascertain that the appropriate individuals have access to the appropriate data at the appropriate time and provide protection of personal data as defined by Republic Act (RA) No. 10173, otherwise known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

In alignment with the National Cybersecurity Plan 2023-2028 (NCSP 2023-2028) and Executive Order No. 58, which mandates the adoption and implementation of the NCSP 2023-2028 as the comprehensive roadmap for the country's cybersecurity development, this policy is designed to enhance our cybersecurity posture. The planning and development of this policy include referencing applicable laws and regulatory issuances, ISO/IEC International Standards on Information Technology, international frameworks from other Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT) bodies, documented best practices of establishing, managing, and operationalizing CERTs from other countries, as well as publicly and internet-available published documents on standards and practices related to computer security.

1.2 Management and Leadership Commitment

The Department of Information and Communications Technology - Caraga Regional Office's leadership is committed to embedding information security throughout the internal personnel, ensuring that the practices are integrated into the organization and agency, resources are available, policy is communicated, and information security is constantly reviewed and enhanced.

1.3 Purpose

The DICT-Caraga Region shall protect restricted, confidential, or sensitive data from loss to de-escalate vulnerability and avoid reputation damage adversely impacting its services to the public. This policy is being issued to protect the Department's data, as well as information and communications technology resources, from intrusion and misuses as required under existing laws and applicable issuances, rules and regulations.

1.4 Scope

This policy applies to all DICT-Caraga Region's personnel including organic and job-order workers, as well as to all information, including intangible and physical assets, computer systems and data. This policy applies wherever the DICT-Caraga Region's data is processed.

This policy aims to protect the DICT-Caraga Region, its employees and partners from illegal or unauthorized use of the DICT's ICT resources. It does not aim to impose unnecessary restrictions that are contrary to the DICT's established culture of openness, trust and integrity.



1.5 Objectives

In alignment with the Information Security Triad of Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability, this policy aims to:

1. Protect the image and reputation of DICT-Caraga Region as a responsible technology enabler.
2. Facilitate the compliance of the DICT-Caraga Region, its employees and partners with existing laws, rules, and regulations.
3. Ensure accuracy, reliability, security, and privacy of the DICT-Caraga Region, its employees and partners' systems, information, and network.
4. Encourage the responsible and controlled use of ICT Resources;
5. Discourage practices which degrade the usability of ICT resources and thus the value of ICT services;
6. Preserve the privacy and security of individual users; and
7. Manage risks to information security with clearly defined and implemented corrective measures.

1.6 Education and Awareness

Suitable information security awareness, training and education shall be provided among DICT-Caraga Region's internal and external stakeholders. External groups must receive ample information campaigns, brochures and materials, including excerpts from the policy, which describe the policy's purpose, services offered, and how to utilize the CERT Services.

1.7 Definitions

Access Control	Ensuring that access to assets is authorized and restricted based on business and security requirements.
Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)	Non-DICT ICT resources or ICT resources brought by DICT employees.
Compensating Security Controls	Management, operational, and/or technical control (i.e., safeguard or countermeasure) used by an organization in place of a suggested security control in the low, moderate, or high baselines that provides an information system with equivalent or comparable protection.
Compliance Statement	A document that sets forth a mutual agreement between the DICT and an employee, where the DICT is lending its resources to the employee for the fulfillment of the latter's duties and responsibilities. The Compliance Statement contains the terms of use for the specific resources.
Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT)	A group of individuals organized to develop and recommend, and coordinate immediate mitigation actions for containment, eradication, and recovery resulting from computer security incidents.



Contract of Service	Engagement of the services of an individual private firm, another government agency, a non-governmental agency or an international organization as consultant, learning service provider or technical expert to undertake special projects or jobs within a specific period.
Critical Information Infrastructure (CII) or Critical Infostructure	The computer systems, and/or networks whether physical or virtual, and/or the computer programs, computer data and/or traffic data that are vital to this country that the incapacity or destruction of or interference with such system and assets would have a debilitating impact on security, national or economic security, national health and safety or any combination of those matters.
Data Breach	When information or assets have been accessed, moved or changed without permission. Also referred to as a data spill or data leak.
DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH	The internal Computer Emergency Response Team of DICT Caraga Regional Office
Digital Forensics	Involves retrieving information from a mobile phone, computer or server. Analyzing for evidence of a data breach or finding deleted messages detailing criminal activity.
Documented Information	Information required to be controlled and maintained by an organization and the medium on which it is contained.
Endpoint	Devices that are connected to a network may be identified as Laptops, desktops, mobile phones, tablets, servers, and virtual environments.
Endpoint Protection	Software installed on a device that provides protection from malicious attacks such as malware infection on a device.
End User-Administrator Agreement	Document that sets forth an agreement between the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH and an End User, that provides the latter with Administrator Privilege on issued DICT devices such as laptops and desktops.
Group Email	Single email address wherein any email sent to it will automatically be forwarded to all email accounts subscribed under said group.
Information and Communications Technology (ICT)	All types of widespread technology used for acquiring, storing, transmitting, retrieving, or processing information
Information Security	Preservation of confidentiality, integrity and availability of information.
Information Security Incident	Single or a series of unwanted or unexpected information security events that have a significant probability of compromising business operations and threatening information security.



Information System	Set of applications, services, information technology assets, or other information-handling components.
Information System Owner	Designated authority accountable for overseeing the comprehensive process of acquiring, constructing, incorporating, adapting, or maintaining an information system.
Information Technology Resource	Defined as, but not limited to: computer equipment and computer facilities; networks, including wired and wireless, networking and communications equipment, cabling infrastructure and access to usage of the Department's networks; user accounts and passwords usage and information access privileges; data files, data storage devices, and servers; computer applications, software, and services; internet access and usage; email access and usage and data records, computer software and documentation.
Job Order Worker	Worker hired for piece work or an intermittent job of a short duration not exceeding six months, where pay is on a daily or hourly basis.
PNS ISO/IEC 27001	Philippine National Standard that provides requirements for establishing, implementing, maintaining, and continually improving an information security management system.
Malware	A piece of software that can compromise operating systems and leave them vulnerable to attack.
Office Custodian	Administrative staff of DICT offices and units who is in charge of monitoring office resources and ICT equipment.
Passphrase	A relatively long password constructed with multiple words, instead of only one or two words, which provides greater security against dictionary attacks.
Risk	Associated with the potential that threats will exploit vulnerabilities of an information asset or group of information assets and thereby cause harm to an organization.
Risk Analysis	Process to comprehend the nature of risk and to determine the level of risk.
Risk Assessment	Overall process of risk identification, risk analysis and risk evaluation.
Risk Identification	Process of finding, recognizing and describing risks.
Risk Management	Coordinated activities to direct and control an organization, concerning risk.
Secure Shell (SSH)	A program to log into another computer over a network, to execute commands in a remote machine, and to move files from one machine to another. It provides strong authentication and secure communications over unsecure channels.



System Owner	An employee(s) having responsibility for the development, procurement, integration, modification, operation, maintenance, and/or final disposition of an information system.
Telnet	A network protocol that's responsible for maintaining a bidirectional interactive communications facility on the Internet or Local Area Networks (LANs).
Compliance Statement	Refers to a document signifying a trust agreement between the DICT and the employee where the DICT is lending its resources to the employee for the fulfillment of the latter's duties and responsibilities. The trust receipt contains the terms of use of the specific resources.
User Account Request Form (UARF)	Form that will be filled out when a user needs to request a new account for the system. Only those with an official DICT email shall be able to accomplish the UARF.
Vulnerability	Weakness of an asset or control that can be exploited by one or more threats.



CHAPTER 2: GENERAL POLICIES

2.1 Internet Usage Monitoring and Filtering Policy

This policy establishes guidelines for systems that monitor internet activity from any host on the DICT Caraga's network. This policy aims to ensure that personnel use the Internet safely and responsibly, as well as to enable monitoring and examination of their internet usage during an incident. Listed below are the requirements to be complied with:

- a. **Web Site Access Monitoring** - The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall be responsible for monitoring internet usage from all information technology (IT) resources connected to the Department's network. The monitoring system shall keep track of the source IP address, the date and time, the protocol, and the server or site destination for all traffic. Wherever possible, the system shall log the User Identification (ID) of the individual or account that initiated the traffic.
- b. **Access to Web Site Monitoring Reports** - The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall have access to all data and reports in performing the computer emergency response duties. Internet usage reports identifying specific users, sites, teams, or devices shall be made available to associates outside the CERT only upon written or email request from the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH
- c. **Internet Usage Filtering System** - The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall restrict access to internet websites and protocols deemed to be incompatible with the DICT operating environment. The following protocols and website categories shall be restricted:
 - a. Spam, Phishing and Fraud
 - b. Malicious and Offensive Content
- d. **Internet Usage Filtering Rule Changes** - The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH in collaboration with the Administration and Finance Division - Human Resource Management, shall review and recommend changes to web and protocol filtering rules periodically.
- e. **Internet Use Filtering Exceptions** - Permission shall be required for employees to access blocked websites when it is appropriate and necessary for work-related purposes. If a site is blocked and is required for a critical operation, employees may request its unblocking by submitting a formal request (*via Google Form*) to the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH Helpdesk. The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall review the request and if the site is miscategorized, it shall be unblocked with the approval of the TOD Chief.
- f. **DICT Internet Official Use** - Official usage of the DICT Caraga Region's internet shall include, but is not limited to:
 - a. Using the internet to access work-related information;
 - b. Sending emails to colleagues on work-related matters;
 - c. Sending emails outside of the work environment on work-related matters;
 - d. Using the internet to support work-related study; and
 - e. Networking with colleagues and peers provided that this does not breach confidentiality or privacy obligations.



2.2 Risk Assessment Policy

The DICT Caraga Region shall establish a standard internal risk assessment guideline throughout its ICT systems, encompassing but not limited to:

- a. List of assets at an appropriate level of granularity:**
 - Comprehensive enumeration of assets at an appropriate level of granularity
- b. Operational impact assessment:**
 - Evaluation of the potential impact of risks on day-to-day operations.
- c. Privacy impact assessment:**
 - Assessment of risks related to data privacy and protection
- d. Compliance with the risk acceptance criteria:**
 - Ensuring alignment with predefined risk acceptance criteria.
- e. Consistent results of assessment:**
 - Standardized procedures to ensure consistent assessment outcomes.
- f. Identification of risks:**
 - Thorough identification and documentation of potential risks.
- g. Identification of risk owners:**
 - Assigning responsibility for each identified risk to appropriate stakeholders.
- h. Appropriate controls:**
 - Establishment of suitable controls to mitigate identified risks.
- i. Risk treatment plan:**
 - Development of a plan outlining strategies for risk mitigation and management.

Additionally, the Risk Assessment Document and implementing rules and regulations shall be outlined in a separate, comprehensive document, providing detailed guidance on conducting risk assessments and implementing necessary controls.

2.3 Acceptance of Risk Assessment Policy

The security of the DICT Caraga Region's information and information resources is the responsibility of all DICT Caraga Region Officials, all personnel both organic and job order workers.

Information risk decisions are the responsibility of the Regional Office whose information is the target of the particular risk. Information systems owners shall review the risks to their IT resources and information from the identified security risks and security gaps, and either:

- a. Accept the risks to their information.
- b. Execute Information Security's recommendations and/or other mitigation steps to reduce the risk to an acceptable level.
- c. Transfer the risks as necessary.

DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH is authorized to conduct a periodic review every two years or when there is a significant change in data security risk to determine areas of vulnerability and initiate appropriate remediation thereof.



2.4 Network Communication Policy

The DICT Caraga Region's network shall be segregated from other networks using appropriate security controls. Access to the data must be limited to authorized users. All routers/switches/access points shall comply with the following rules:

- a. Local user accounts must be monitored and updated to ensure they use secure credentials and are not left at default settings.
- b. The enabled password on the router/switch/access points shall be kept in a secure encrypted form.
- c. All routing updates shall be done using secure routing updates.
- d. Access control lists shall be used to limit the source and type of traffic that can terminate on the device itself.
- e. Telnet shall never be used across any network to manage a router unless there is a secure tunnel protecting the entire communication path. SSH version 2 is the preferred management protocol.
- f. Password hashing for the authentication string shall be enabled when supported.

2.5 Password Construction Policy

Employees are encouraged to consider the following recommendations to ensure maximum security with their respective accounts:

- a. End-users' password for DICT internal information systems and applications, email, and other work-related applications shall consist of at least sixteen (16) characters with one (1) upper and one (1) lower case letter, one (1) numerical number, and one (1) symbol.
- b. Systems Administrators' password for all systems and equipment shall consist of at least twenty (20) characters with one (1) upper and one (1) lower case letter, one (1) numerical number, and one (1) symbol.

Employees are encouraged to consider using passphrases, which can provide stronger security. Strong passphrases should include a combination of upper and lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters. It is also recommended that employees use different passwords for different applications or systems.

While not mandatory, it is suggested that passwords be changed regularly, at least every ninety (90) days or three (3) months from their inception.

Employees shall avoid disclosing passwords or making them accessible by and available to unauthorized persons under any circumstances.

Employees are encouraged to use strong passwords or passphrases on their personal accounts and should avoid reusing personal passwords for corporate accounts.



2.6 Protected Data / Information Policy

There shall be proper handling, storage, and destruction of protected electronic information/data, whether stored or shared electronically. The DICT Region 13 CERT-PH shall be responsible for preventing the loss of restricted, confidential, or sensitive data to de-escalate vulnerability and avoid reputation damage adversely impacting its services to the public.

All employees shall familiarize themselves with the information labeling and handling principles, where only the intended audience or authorized individuals shall see or have an opportunity to see or modify information/data.

The following guidelines shall be observed:

- a. Employees of DICT Caraga Region shall complete security awareness training provided by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH and agree to adhere to the acceptable use guidelines.
- b. All guests and visitors of the Regional Office shall be always escorted by an authorized employee. Visitors are restricted entry to any critical areas of the work premises.
- c. All DICT Caraga Region employees shall maintain a clean desk, in accordance with Clean and Clear Desk policy. To ensure data security, employees shall ensure that no sensitive data or materials are left unattended on their workstations.
- d. DICT Caraga Region employees shall use a secure password on all systems, as mandated by Password Construction Policy. These credentials must be unique and must not be used on other external systems or services.
- e. If a DICT Caraga Region employee discovers a system or process that is not compliant with this provision, he or she is responsible for notifying the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH so that appropriate actions can be taken.
- f. If a DICT Caraga Region employee is assigned to work remotely, he or she must take additional precautions to ensure that internal data is handled appropriately. The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall be consulted for guidance on responsibility guidelines.
- g. All information systems utilized by DICT Caraga Region shall undergo a risk assessment process as stated in the Risk Assessment Policy not limited to vulnerability assessment and penetration testing and privacy impact assessment prior to usage.
- h. All employees shall ensure that assets containing sensitive data and information are not exposed excessively.
- i. All data on returned devices must be wiped out before they are replaced.
- j. Employees, whether permanent or contractual, including Job Order Workers, Consultants who because of retirement, resignation, termination, separation, or suspension from the service, shall be required to delete all records containing personal and sensitive data/information regardless of the format.



The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH can back up data from end-user devices for 30 days after the last working day of the notice period. This data can be requested by an employee's Immediate Supervisor through a formal request. This requirement shall be incorporated in the onboarding process and a written compliance statement as stated in **Annex C**, signed by the concerned party, as a manifestation of their compliance thereof.

2.7 Human Resource Security Policy

The following Human Resources Security procedures shall be implemented:

- a. **Personnel Orientation on Information Security** - All employees shall formalize their understanding of the following security measures through the signing of a document upon onboarding with the Administration and Finance Division – Human Resource Management. Employees shall:
 - i. Report all suspicious activities and the usage of ICT resources that may constitute a violation of these acceptable guidelines.
 - ii. Protect any sensitive or vulnerable data/information.
 - iii. Exercise caution when opening files and attachments from unknown or untrusted sources.
 - iv. Refrain from transmitting, storing, or receiving data/material, and/or using IT resources that are unlawful, obscene, threatening, child pornographic content, abusive, libelous, or encourages conduct that constitutes a criminal offense, civil liability, or any violation to any existing laws, regulations, and other applicable issuances.
 - v. Respect software copyright and licenses and other intellectual property rights.
 - vi. Respect the rights of other computer users.
 - vii. Take appropriate precautions such as safeguarding their account and password, taking full advantage of file security mechanisms, backing up critical data, and promptly reporting any misuse or violations of this policy.
- b. **Personnel Transfer** - The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall review system access authorizations when personnel is reassigned or transferred to another position and workstation within the Department and initiate appropriate actions such as closing and establishing accounts and changing system access authorization.
- c. **Personnel Separation** - Upon separation of individual employment, the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall immediately suspend user ID and personnel shall relinquish data and information and return ICT resources to the Department subject to the provision of Section 2.6 (j).



2.8 Clean and Clear Desk Policy

The following shall be the minimum requirements for maintaining a “clean and clear desk”, where sensitive/critical information about DICT Caraga Region employees, intellectual property, stakeholders, and other internal resources are secure and out of sight in locked areas:

- a. Employees shall be responsible for securing all sensitive/confidential information, whether in hardcopy or electronic form, in their work area at the end of the day and when they anticipate being gone for an extended period.
- b. Computer workstations shall be locked when the workspace is unoccupied.
- c. Computer workstations shall be shut down completely at the end of the working hours unless receiving updates during off-hours.
- d. Treat mass storage devices such as Hard Disk Drives, USB drives, or CD Drives as sensitive and shall be secured in a safe area.
- e. Whiteboards containing restricted and/or sensitive information shall be erased.
- f. When the desk is unoccupied or at the end of the workday, any restricted or sensitive data/information shall be removed from the desk and locked in a drawer or other secure location.
- g. All printers and fax machines shall be cleared of papers with sensitive information as soon as they are printed.
- h. Passwords shall not be left on sticky notes attached to or beneath a computer or written down in an easily accessible location.
- i. Upon disposal, restricted and/or sensitive documents shall be shredded in the official shredder bins or placed in locked disposal bins.
- j. File cabinets containing restricted or sensitive information and documents shall be kept closed and locked when not in use or when not attended.
- k. Any materials such as keys used for access to restricted or sensitive information shall not be left at an unattended desk.
- l. Laptops shall be secured using a locking cable or stored in a drawer.
- m. Print-outs containing restricted or sensitive data shall be discarded immediately.
- n. Portable computing devices such as laptops and tablets shall be placed in a secure location.

2.9 Cloud Data Storage Management Policy

All DICT Caraga Region Employees; Organic, Job Order Personnel, and Contract of Service Personnel shall have the responsibility for protecting all data of the Department stored in its Cloud Storage as provided. All concerned personnel shall observe the following:



- a. The use of Cloud Storage shall adhere to the Office policies and procedures governing ethical behavior, workplace safety, compliance with applicable laws, and proper agency practices, as may be referenced in Department Circular No. 2017-002, otherwise known as the Philippine Cloud First Policy, and its amendment Department Circular No. 010, series of 2020, as well as, other related policies that may be issued in the future;
- b. Cloud Storage should not be used for long-term retention of the Department's documents or files including non-sensitive information. Alternatives such as shared network drives are advisable.
- c. On using Cloud Storage for collaboration, either within the Department or externally, grant access only to files or folders that are required for collaboration and should be given on a strictly need-to-know basis.

2.10 Usage of ICT Equipment Policy

All employees shall adhere to the following administrative protocols and standards for using ICT equipment owned by the Department to ensure their proper use and handling while carrying out their duties under alternative work arrangements:

- a. **Issuance of ICT Equipment to DICT Caraga Region Employees** - All ICT equipment issued to permanent employees must be accompanied by a Property Accountability Receipt (PAR) signed by both the employee and the responsible unit or regional office head. The user of the ICT equipment, as specified in the PAR, is accountable for and responsible for the ICT equipment's safekeeping.

The Technical Operations Division, DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH, and Administration and Finance Division shall inspect and activate all computers officially issued by the Department. The Administration and Finance Division shall then affix a seal or sticker to signify that the devices have been inspected. The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH, with the assistance of Administration and Finance Division, shall also install and configure endpoint protection on the devices.

In case of resignation, separation, and retirement from the service, the ICT equipment shall be returned to the respective office before the issuance of Clearance and all personal credentials of the user shall be removed from the ICT equipment.

- b. **Software and Hardware Security** - Users shall follow general measures and best practices in software and hardware security while using office ICT equipment.
 - i. **Session-locking and Password Protection** - Session-locking should always be implemented on personal computers (PCs) and laptops to prevent access to the device after it has been idle for a period and can only be restored through authentication.

ICT equipment such as laptops and storage devices shall have a strong and secure password.



- ii. **Software Installation** - For purposes of complying with copyright laws and minimizing computer threats, only DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH authorized software must be installed on computers and laptops. These software installations shall only be done by authorized DICT personnel. Should a user require specific software to carry out his/her official function, the user shall inform the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH via email or in a formal request. The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall approve the software before the user can proceed with the installation.
 - iii. **Software Updates** - Operating systems and software applications should always be configured to automatically access vendors' online services frequently to check for updates and download and install them. Software updates including Firmware, Operating Software, Drivers and Plug-ins updates shall be done regularly and whenever necessary to ensure that computers have the latest security updates.
 - iv. **Networks and Devices** - ICT equipment shall only be connected to secure networks to maintain the integrity of data and prevent breaches and any incidents thereof. Users should be prohibited from installing any equipment (Network or Computer Peripherals) without DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH's approval. In the case of mobile devices, limit networking capabilities by turning off Bluetooth and shared wireless networking.
 - v. **Backup** - Users shall maintain a backup of their files. Regular backups shall be encouraged to ensure that recent files are covered. Backups shall be stored in a safe and secure medium. Data that is backed-up remotely shall be encrypted.
- c. **Physical Security** - The facilities that house the Department's information and technology resources shall be protected with physical security measures that prevent unauthorized persons from gaining access to the equipment and that lessen the risks of theft, destruction, and/or misuse.

All servers and network equipment shall be physically secured, controlled and access shall be restricted only to authorized individuals.

Locations, where information is processed, shall completely be controlled, and access shall be restricted only to authorized individuals.

The Department shall create and maintain a specific list of responsible persons who are authorized to control and grant access to the facilities that contain information technology resources. Controlling staff and visitors is necessary and access records to staff and visitors shall be maintained.

Inventory records of computer equipment shall be kept up to date. The master inventory shall be maintained by the Administration and Finance Division in coordination with relevant units in the Department.

The user shall take all necessary precautions to safeguard the ICT equipment and prevent the breach and unauthorized access. The user shall take full accountability for the ICT equipment whenever the ICT equipment is taken outside the office premises. The security of the said equipment shall be equivalent to on-site use of the same wherever possible.



By removing ICT equipment from office premises, users acknowledge the increased risk of theft and/or loss, thus, users must take all necessary precautions to protect the ICT equipment.

In case of loss, the user shall immediately report the incident to the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH with the acknowledgement of the respective unit or division within 48 hours. The user shall be held accountable for the loss, subject to government rules and regulations.

- d. **Compensating Security Controls** - Exceptions shall only be made where security measures cause operational issues or where specific workstations and networks are required to not have such controls. In this case, the following compensating security controls shall be considered:
- i. Computers shall only be used in a secure environment. An environment is secure when appropriate controls are established to protect computer software, hardware, and information. These controls shall provide a measure of protection commensurate with the classification of the data and the assessed risks.
 - ii. Secure user identification and authentication shall be used on all devices, applications, and systems software.
 - iii. The DICT computing and network-connected devices shall utilize an access control system that provides privilege control as well as change control, and shall employ software that restricts access to the files of each user, logs the activities of each user, and has special privileges granted to a systems administrator. Portable computers and home computers that contain the Department's information are also covered by this policy.
 - iv. All DICT computing and network-connected devices shall be as fully protected as possible from malicious computer hacking and all forms of malware including computer viruses, worms, trojan horses, rootkits, bots, crimeware, and all other malicious and unwanted software, including new types not listed here. These systems shall be regularly examined to assure their compliance with this policy.
 - v. All software running on devices connected to the DICT's network shall utilize the latest security updates provided by the software vendor or the DICT consistent with international standards.
 - vi. Malware-infected computers shall be immediately disconnected from the network until they are verified as malware-free.
 - vii. Installation of programs on a Department-owned or -issued computer shall only be performed by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH.
 - viii. To help protect against malware being distributed over the network, the following rules shall be observed by all employees:
 - 1. Devices provided by the DICT, through the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH, shall only connect to the DICT Office Wi-Fi Network when working on the premises of the Department to minimize the risk of malware infection from unprotected computers;



devices that are used in operations but are not issued by the Department shall only connect to the DICT Guest Network.

2. Employees shall not perform any action on any emails that suggest they have been sent to fix a problem with their machine (e.g., emails seemingly from Microsoft); and
3. Employees shall not open suspicious emails and shall contact the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH immediately to report any suspicious activity.

ix. Anti-virus scans shall be done a minimum of once per week on all workstations and servers used by the DICT end-users or employees.

x. If a computer is found or suspected to have malware, employees shall:

1. Contact the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH immediately.
2. Do not use the computer until reuse has been approved by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH

xi. Anti-virus updates and anti-virus scans shall not be interrupted except by DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH.

2.11 Email Policy

This policy is intended to ensure proper use of the DICT Gov Mail system and to educate users about what signifies acceptable and unacceptable use of the system. This policy establishes guidelines for the use of the agency's email within its network:

1. All use of DICT GovMail shall adhere to the Office policies and procedures governing ethical behavior, workplace safety, compliance with applicable laws, and proper agency practices, as may be referenced in the DOST-Information and Communications Technology Office Memorandum Circular No. 2015-002.¹
2. All DICT's data contained within an email message or an attachment shall be secured according to the Data Protection Policy guidelines.
3. The DICT GovMail email system shall not be used to create or distribute disruptive or offensive messages, including comments about gender, race, skin color, disabilities, age, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE), pornography, religious and political beliefs, or national origin. Employees who receive emails containing this content from any other employee shall immediately notify their supervisor.
4. The DICT GovMail email system shall not be used to create or distribute disruptive or offensive messages, including comments about gender, race, skin color, disabilities, age, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE), pornography, religious and political beliefs, or national origin. Employees who receive emails containing this content from any other employee shall immediately notify their supervisor. It is encouraged that employees shall create an email signature.
5. Whenever an employee, consultant, or any other agent of the DICT is assigned a GovMail account, the use of such an account for all official communications shall be mandatory.
6. The DICT e-mail account holders shall observe a standard email signature with the following format:

¹ Memorandum Circular No. 2015-002, "Prescribing the GovMail Service Guidelines for Philippine Government Agencies."



Complete Employee Name

Position/Designation

Bureau/Service/Office

Agency Name

Agency Address

Telephone/Local Number/Fax Number

Mobile Number <Official Number>

Email Address

DICT URL

7. DICT employees are expected to attach only work-related files in the email. Sharing prohibited executable files that may be destructive for the system or contain malicious software or virus are not allowed.
8. Group emails may be created by each DICT unit, particular projects, ad hoc inter-unit endeavors, and other similar uses. A Group is a single email address to which any email sent will automatically be forwarded to all email accounts subscribed under such Group. As it contributes to convenience and efficiency, the judicious use of Groups is encouraged. Subscription to and removal from Groups shall be managed by the MISS.
9. Email Account and Messages Retention
 - a. Individuals who are no longer connected with the DICT by reason of resignation, transfer of office, retirement, or other causes for termination or suspension of service, shall be prohibited from accessing the DICT.gov.ph domain either through account deactivation. In every instance of effective separation from the DICT, the Administration and Finance Division – Human Resource Management shall communicate such facts to the Postmaster so that proper egress measures may be undertaken with respect to the account of such former employee.
 - b. Email account deactivation shall occur promptly after the employee's departure date, ensuring that the individual no longer has access to their email. A backup procedure will be initiated, allowing 3 to 5 days for the personnel to secure any necessary data before account deactivation.
 - c. Users of DICT.gov.ph are responsible for clearing up storage spaces from their respective DICT.gov.ph accounts. Users should judge the content of the e-mail based on its relevance to their work and importance of e-mail.
10. Reasonable use of the ***dict.gov.ph*** domain for personal electronic correspondence is acceptable. However, strict professional discretion is still expected from the employee at all times and shall be bound by the provisions of the Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees (R.A. 6713).

2.12 Access Control Policy

Access to the DICT information technology resources and information shall be authorized by the DICT Caraga Regional Director, with the recommendation from the TOD Chief.

All access shall be granted using a single, non-shared user ID. When staff members leave, or no longer require access, all access accounts shall be suspended or terminated.



Requests for new User IDs for officials and employees shall be requested via the User Access Request Form (UARF) (*please refer to **Annex A***) by the concerned unit.

The use of a Bring-Your-Own-Device (BYOD) or personally-owned computer or mobile computing devices such as tablets, smartphones, etc., or any of its parts to connect to the DICT network or access to internal resources shall be permitted thru accomplished UARF. DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall establish a separate network for BYOD devices. Guests shall only be allowed to connect to the Wi-Fi network intended for guests to minimize the risks of malware infection from unprotected computers.

All users shall sign the compliance statement document (*please refer to **Annex B***), indicating that the user understands and agrees to abide by the standards and procedures related to access to the DICT's computers and networks. The ICT Equipment Acceptable Use Policy is given and signed by the end-user once they have been issued a DICT procured device.

Requests for Administrator Privilege shall only be allowed for officials and employees who are system owners and shall only be granted after the signature and approval of the End-User - Administrator Agreement.

Documentation regarding user access requests and changes shall be retained for at least three (3) years.

2.13 Information Security Incident Response Policy

The DICT Caraga Region shall follow established policies and procedures to address indications that the security of the IT resources may have been compromised. Such procedures shall include ensuring that the appropriate level of management is involved in determining responses to an IT security incident:

- a. Detected incidents, both real and suspected, shall be properly reported to the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH, recorded, and documented.
- b. For real incidents, the root cause shall be established, and remedial controls shall be recommended and implemented where possible.
- c. All evidence shall be gathered, recorded, and maintained.
- d. Depending on the circumstances, forensic analysis and investigation shall be required.
- e. All reported incidents, both internal and external, shall be acknowledged by DICT-CERT-PH.

Security Incidents shall include, but are not limited to:

- a. Actions intended to harm or illegally access the Department's resources or information.
- b. A breach, attempted breach, or other unauthorized access of the Department's information technology resource and information. The incident may originate within the network or from the outside.
- c. Conduct using in whole or in part, an information technology resource, and information that can be construed as harassment or in violation of any existing policies, laws, and regulations.
- d. Action or attempt to utilize, alter, or degrade a department's owned or operated information technology resource in a manner inconsistent with existing policies.
- e. Unwanted disruption or denial of service against the Department's information technology resource or information.
- f. Unauthorized use of an information technology resource or information; and
- g. Changes to system hardware, firmware, or software characteristics without the owner's knowledge, instruction, or consent.



Incident Reporting shall be promptly submitted to the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH when,

- a. Intrusion attempts, security breaches, theft or loss of hardware, and other security-related incidents have been perpetrated against the Department.
- b. There is knowledge or reasonable suspicion of an incident that violates the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of information.
- c. A virus, worm, bot, rootkit, or other malware has been discovered.
- d. There is knowledge or reasonable suspicion of a Security Incident.

Incident reports shall include:

- a. Description of the incident/events.
- b. Approximate timelines.
- c. Parties Involved.
- d. Resolution of the Incident, if any.

Incident Actions shall include the following, to wit:

- a. If the incident appears to involve a compromised computer system, the state of the computer system shall not be altered. The computer system shall remain turned on, all currently running computer programs shall be left as is, and the computer shall not be used until directed otherwise by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH.
- b. Whenever system security has been compromised or if there is a convincing reason to believe that it has been compromised:
 - i. All passwords residing on the system or entered the system shall be immediately changed by the person responsible for the account.
 - ii. A trusted version of the operating system and all security-related software shall be reloaded from trusted storage media such as an external hard drive, time capsule, or original installation media.
 - iii. All changes to user privileges taking effect since the time of suspected system compromise shall be immediately reviewed by the systems administrator for unauthorized modifications.

In case there is a need for Digital Forensic, the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH will endorse the said device to the CII sectoral lead for further actions.

2.14 Data Breach Policy

Any individual who suspects theft, breach, or exposure of protected information or any sensitive data has occurred shall immediately notify the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH Helpdesk via (R13 CERT Email Support) . The TOD shall inform the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH of the data breach.

The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall conduct initial investigations on all reported thefts, data breaches, and exposures to determine the occurrence of an actual incident. If a theft, breach, or exposure has occurred, the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall follow the appropriate procedures on the classification of data being compromised.



CHAPTER 3: ENFORCEMENT

3.1 Compliance Measurement

The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH will monitor compliance with this policy using a variety of methods, including periodic walk-throughs, video monitoring, operation tool reports, internal and external audits, and feedback on the policy from stakeholders.

Employees shall follow the policy with strict adherence. Any employee, organic, job order, or contract of service found to be guilty of violation of standards or policies, or responsible for a security breach, intentional or otherwise, of the safe, proper, and reasonable use of the DICT ICT resources shall be subject to disciplinary action. Permanent or temporary removal of access privileges shall be arranged when appropriate.

For personnel under Contract of Service (COS), a provision adopting compliance with this Order shall be included in their contract. As such, non-compliance by the COS personnel of this Order shall be construed as a breach of their contractual obligation and shall be a valid ground for termination or cancellation of their services.

All DICT Caraga Region employees shall undergo an orientation regarding the provisions of these policies.

3.2 Exception

Exceptions to this policy shall be approved by the Regional Office Director as endorsed and documented in writing by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH. Policy exceptions shall be reviewed for appropriateness periodically.

3.3 Amendment Clause

As the need arises, these policies may be amended by the DICT Caraga Region after due consultation with affected stakeholders.

3.4 Separability Clause

If for any reason, any provision or part of this Policy or the application of such provision or part to any person, group or circumstance is declared invalid or unconstitutional, the remainder of this policy shall not be affected by such declaration and shall remain in full force and effect.

3.5 Transitory Provisions

Risk Assessment shall be conducted by the DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH upon approval of these policies to establish a baseline of risks associated with the loss of confidentiality, integrity and availability of data as well as ICT resources within the DICT. The DICT-Region 13 CERT-PH shall establish a mechanism to separate the connection of all BYOD devices from the official devices that are connected to the DICT Caraga Region internal network.



CHAPTER 4: REFERENCES

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User Account Request Form
DICT-MISS-UARF-2022v1.7

READ THE INSTRUCTIONS BEFORE FILLING OUT THE FORM:

- 1. Fill out this form completely and accurately.
- 2. Tick the checkbox of **DATA PRIVACY STATEMENT**.
- 3. Do not leave any information blank.
- 4. Do not abbreviate (e.g., MISS should be Management Information Systems Service)
- 5. Multiple requests of account are per one system only.
- 6. You may enter the following details in the **Employment Status** field: *Permanent/Organic, Highly Technical Consultant, Job Order/Contract of Service, or Co-Terminus.*
- 7. When your request is completed, you will be notified through the e-mail address provided on this form.
- 8. You may contact miss@dict.gov.ph to follow up on your request.

ADDITIONAL INSTRUCTIONS FOR GOVMAIL ACCOUNTS:

- 1. The following Account Types should be endorsed by duly authorized persons:
 - a. **Staff Accounts** - Creation, Modification, and Suspension/Deletion should be signed and endorsed by the HRMD.
 - b. **Non-Staff Accounts** - Creation, Modification, and Suspension/Deletion should be signed and endorsed by at least the Director
 - c. **Mailing/Distribution List** - Creation, Modification, and Suspension/Deletion should be signed and endorsed by at least the Division Chief
- 2. Request to increase Storage Space shall require the following
 - a. A 90% threshold for storage utilization must have been reached by the user. (Screenshot of actual usage)
 - b. Letter of request addressed to:

ANGEL V. SOBREPENA III
OIC Chief, Network Administration, and Security Division
Department of Information and Communication Technology
DICT Bldg., C.P. Garcia, Diliman, Quezon City

☐ DATA PRIVACY STATEMENT

The registrants are assured that the personal data and other sensitive data entrusted to DICT shall be used with due diligence and prudence, for the sole purpose of account registration. As such, upon filling out the User Account Request form, you acknowledge and agree that the information may be used and disclosed by the DICT in accordance with any legal and regulatory standards and in compliance with the “Data Privacy Act of 2012”.

Reference No.		Date of Request		
GENERAL INFORMATION				
Contact Person		Designation		
Bureau/Office/Service		Division/Project		
Email Address		Mobile/ Local Number		
USER ACCOUNT DETAILS				
Full Name	Position/Designation	Email Address	User Role (Refer to Annex A)	Employment Status
(Attach additional sheet if necessary)				
DETAILS OF REQUEST				
Reason of Request	☐ New User Account ☐ Modify User Account ☐ Deactivation of Account			
Information System/Productivity Tools/Network & Security	☐ Intranet ☐ PMIS ☐ eOR ☐ Project Online ☐ Zoom ☐ NAS Access			Others (Please specify)
	☐ eHRMIS ☐ DocTracks ☐ MS Office 365 ☐ Power BI ☐ Network Captive Portal			
	☐ Virtual Private Network (VPN) ☐ Govmail Account			
Detailed Statement of Request				
ENDORSEMENT (to be filled out by Requesting Unit Supervisor or concerned Official)				
Signature Over Printed Name				
STATUS (to be filled out by MISS)				
☐ Approved ☐ Approved as modified ☐ Disapproved ☐ Withdrawn by Requester				
NOTES (to be filled out by MISS)				
NOTED BY (to be filled out by MISS)				
LEAD, MISS-DWAD/MISS-NASD				
APPROVAL (to be filled out by MISS)				
CHIEF, MISS-DWAD/MISS-NASD				

[illegible]



USER ACCOUNT REQUEST FORM
DICT-MISS-UARF-2022v1.7

ANNEX A: INTERNAL SYSTEMS USER ROLES

DICT INTRANET	
ROLE	DESCRIPTION
MEMBER	View all contents of their own office or the whole DICT. Time in and out to the system.
CONTENT MANAGER	Responsible in managing their own office, Downloadable Forms, FAQ Section, Calendar of Activities
ILCDB OFFICER	Responsible in managing Trainings.

DOCUMENT TRACKING SYSTEM (Doctracks)	
ROLE	DESCRIPTION
ACTION OFFICER	Received and route internal documents. (DICT offices only)
RECORDS OFFICER	Received and route incoming, outgoing and internal documents. (DICT offices and external agency/ies)

Electronic Official Receipt (eOR)	
ROLE	DESCRIPTION
OP CREATOR	Refers to the user who prepare the Order of Payment
OP APPROVER	Refers to the user who review and approve the Order of Payment
OR GENERATOR	Refers to user who manage payment of payer and issue eOR
OR CANCELLATOR	Refers to user who manage the cancelation of eOR

Program Management Information System (PMIS)	
ROLE	DESCRIPTION
PMIS FOCAL	Manage Budget Execution Documents(BEDs) and Monthly Physical Accomplishment Report (MPAR)
HEAD OF SERVICE/BUREAU/PMT/ RDO	Review and approves BEDs as Head of Office
APPROVING ASEC	Review and approve BEDs as approving ASEC
APPROVING USEC	Review and approve BEDs as approving USEC
OBSERVER	View only Role
TOD	Manage Regional Implementation for Regional Offices



COMPLIANCE STATEMENT
(DECLARATION OF UNDERTAKING)

I, Mr./Ms. _____ of the *Technical Operations Division – (Project/Section)* of the Department of Information and Communications Technology – Caraga Region, have been issued a company Device with the following specifications:

Device Type : (e.g., *Laptop*)
Brand Model : (e.g., *ASUS EXPERTBOOK P2451F*)
Processor : (e.g., *Intel Core i5 / Windows 10*)
Memory : (e.g., *8GB Ram*)
Storage : (e.g., *1TB / 200GB SSD*)
Serial Number : (e.g., *M9NXCV206815396*)

I confirm that I fully understand the following:

1. The use of the DICT's IT Resource(s) is **ONLY** for its **INTENDED PURPOSE**, and I shall not **MISUSE OR ABUSE** it;
2. I am obligated to take care of the IT Resource(s) and its accessories to the best of my ability;
3. In case of theft, damage or loss of the IT Resource(s) while under my custody, I will be accountable for immediately notifying the Commission on Audit (COA) or the auditor concerned within thirty (30) days, and present my application for relief with the available supporting evidence(s). Failure on my part to comply with this requirement shall not relieve me of the liability or be allowed credit for any loss in the settlement of this account;¹
4. I shall not take the IT Resource(s) for repair to any agency or vendor outside of the DICT;
5. The IT Resource(s) and any other accessories or components must be returned to the DICT immediately upon termination of my services, or at any other time as specifically directed by the management;
6. I am responsible for backing-up all data or records in the IT Resource(s). The DICT Region 13-CERT-PH shall not be liable for any loss of data or records due to damaged hardware or software malfunction, and shall not incur any cost in the reconstitution, recreation and recovery of any such data or records; and

¹ Chapter 2, §3, c-4 of the Commission on Audit - Government Accounting Manual for National Government Agencies (COA-GAMNGA); and §73 of Presidential Declaration No. 1445.

7. The use of this IT Resource(s) is(are) governed by and subject to the rules and conditions of Regional Office Order No. ____, s. 2024 entitled: “*DICT Caraga Region Information Security Policy*”, and other relevant laws, applicable rules and regulations of the Republic of the Philippines.

I have received the following items with my Device, and I am responsible for replacing any lost items at the time that the Device is returned:

**Check the boxes that apply; leave blank if not applicable.*

	Accessories List	Quantity
	Power Adaptor	1
	Mouse	1
	Laptop Bag	1

I am aware that the provisions of this Compliance Statement and such pertinent laws shall apply in this Undertaking. I agree with the above terms and conditions and will fully cooperate with property loss reporting requirements and property loss incident investigations. My signature below indicates that I have thoroughly read and understood the above information.

Failure to abide by this Compliance Statement will result in disciplinary action in accordance with the 2017 Rules on Administrative Cases in the Civil Service (2017 RACCS) as well as any future amendments of the same, and immediate confiscation of the Device.

Received by:

EMPLOYEE NAME

Position, Division

Issued by:

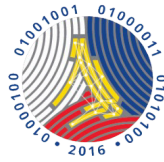
SUPERVISOR NAME

Position, Division

Noted by:

DIVISION CHIEF NAME

Chief, Technical Operations Division



END-USER — ADMINISTRATOR AGREEMENT

IMPORTANT: PLEASE READ THIS DOCUMENT IN ITS ENTIRETY

In line with Regional Office Order No. ___, s. 2024 entitled “*DICT Regional Office 13 Information Security Policy*”, this End-User-Administrator Agreement is a legal and binding agreement between you, as the End-User of the **Mid-Range Laptop with Administrator Privilege** and the DICT Region 13 - Computer Emergency Response Team (DICT Region 13-CERT-PH), as the Administrator.

Upon gaining access to the Administrator Privilege, the End-User shall comply with the following terms and conditions:

1. The End-User shall inform the Administrator prior to the installation of any software.
2. The End-User shall only install legitimate applications/software, licensed applications/software, and/or third-party applications/software (see List at Annex A) approved by the Administrator.
3. Applications/Software which are not included on the list shall be subject to approval by the Administrator.
4. The installation of third-party application(s) from malicious sources shall be strictly prohibited.
5. The antivirus Windows Security Defender software must always be up to date.

Any security incident that stems from non-compliance, such as, but not limited to, security threats, malware attacks found on the End-User’s laptop, shall be the End-User’s responsibility. The Administrator shall not be liable for any compromises and/or incidents.

By signing this document, you agree to be bound by the terms and conditions.

Signed on this ___ day of ____, 20__.

NAME AND SIGNATURE

Team Lead, DICT Region 13-CERT-PH

Division Chief, Technical Operations Division

Annex A: List of Approved Software

A. Commonly Used Third-party Application/Software

<i>Office Productivity</i>	LibreOffice for Linux Adobe Acrobat Reader DC Foxit Reader
<i>Browsing and Streaming</i>	OBS Studio Google Chrome Mozilla Firefox Brave Browser Google Earth
<i>Server Licenses and Development Tools</i>	CentOS 7
<i>Video-conferencing, Remote User Access and Messaging</i>	Anydesk TeamViewer Viber Telegram Messenger Cisco Webex Google Meet Desktop App MS Teams